

FAR FROM FASHION, CLOSE TO PERFECTION

His numbers tell one story, his method another. Sai Sudharsan's success lies in trusting a style that **resists modern urgency.**

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Unlike most of his contemporaries, B. Sai Sudharsan employs a bat-down technique. He awaits the bowler in his crease with the bottom edge of the bat resting on the ground.

He raises his bat to load his shot only when the bowler reaches the popping crease, adjusting the extent of his backswing based on his reading of length and shot choice.

It is a batting style from a bygone era, one that makes the process seem tougher than it should be. For Sai Sudharsan, it is a habit born of childhood frailty, one he has considered changing but ultimately retained.

"I started playing by keeping my bat down when I was young," explains Sai Sudharsan in an interview with *Sportstar*.

"The main reason at the time was that I was not very strong. My coaches would say, 'You're not so strong. So, don't lift your bat. Otherwise, you'll get tired soon. Just keep your bat down.' That's how I started."

"But it is helping me. Yes, I had some temptations in between to change it. But I think I had more trust in this. The way I batted, the set-up I have, I trusted this more," he added.

The 24-year-old's faith in his natural style has brought rich rewards, most notably the Orange Cap in IPL 2025, when he accumulated 759 runs at an impressive strike rate of 156.17 for Gujarat Titans.

That massive haul was the punctuation mark on an upward trajectory that has defined his IPL career: 145 runs in 2022, 362 in 2023, and 527 in 2024.

At the heart of his progression has been a willingness to adapt by adding new shots to his repertoire, particularly behind square. The southpaw has integrated a variety of ramps and scoops into his strokeplay as he has expanded his run-scoring methods.

This evolution has been the result of conscious planning and focused off-season training, driven by a desire to add new tools without unsettling his batting foundation.

"I definitely do it [prepare for such